

INTERNATIONAL news

TSMC receives \$1.95 billion aid from China, Japan

TSMC has received \$1.95 billion (NT\$62.5 billion) in subsidies from China and Japan since 2022, aiding its expansion in Europe and the US. This funding supports TSMC's facilities in Nanjing and Kumamoto and its new fab in Dresden, Germany. Despite its global growth, TSMC has yet to receive US government subsidies.

Shanghai increases semiconductor fund to \$2 billion

The Shanghai government has increased its chip investment fund to approximately CNY 14.5 billion (\$2 billion) to bolster China's semiconductor market, especially for advanced AI chips. This funding, supported by state-backed companies, is part of a broader strategy under the China Integrated Circuit Industry Investment Fund, which has previously invested heavily in major semiconductor firms.

US to grant \$50 million to HP for Oregon fab

The US Commerce Department will award \$50 million to HP under the CHIPS Act to expand and modernise its Corvallis, Oregon fab and R&D facility. The funding will enhance life sciences and AI technologies, leveraging HP's expertise in microfluidics and MEMS. This investment supports advancements in the semiconductor supply chain.

Texas Instruments secures government fund and tax credits for fabs

Texas Instruments has secured \$1.6 billion in funding and \$6.8 billion in tax credits from the US government to build three wafer fabs in Texas and Utah. The facilities will focus on sustainable chip production, operating on renewable energy, and aiming to meet LEED Gold standards. This investment supports the company's broader \$18 billion plan through 2029.

Poland secures EU approval to start construction of a new Intel chip plant

The European Commission has approved Poland's plan to provide over \$1.9 billion in state aid for Intel's new chip plant. The total investment is expected to exceed \$6 billion through 2026. Poland needs to finalise legislation and notify the Commission before concluding the deal. The project, part of the European Chips Act, aims to boost Europe's chip market share and is expected to start construction this year.

Taiwan and Czech Republic plan to partner for a semiconductor hub

Taiwan plans to collaborate with the Czech Republic to establish a semiconductor cluster in Europe, leveraging TSMC's new Dresden fab. Taiwan's National Security Council Secretary-General Joseph Wu emphasised the need for stable infrastructure and skilled talent. Czech officials are open to offering tax incentives to attract Taiwanese investments.

US Chip repairer KoMiCo purchases facility in Arizona for semiconductor cleaning and coating

Texas-based KoMiCo Phoenix LLC has acquired an 11,613 square meter facility in Mesa, Arizona, for \$17.5 million. Scheduled to open in 2026, the site will focus on semiconductor cleaning and coating, generating 200 jobs. With over \$50 million invested, it will be KoMiCo's third US location and eighth globally.

RECOM acquires LECO to strengthen power solutions

RECOM Power has acquired Austria-based LECO, enhancing its power electronics portfolio with new custom and standard solutions for industrial automation. The acquisition aims to leverage LECO's expertise and technology to strengthen RECOM's capacity in AC/DC converter and power supply systems. However, financial details were not disclosed.

VDL denies job cuts amid ASML's potential loss of Chinese market access

ASML's chip equipment supplier, VDL, denied layoff claims, stating it only periodically reduces flexible workers. Meanwhile, due to new US export restrictions, ASML faces a potential loss of Chinese market access. The Dutch government might halt ASML's servicing of DUV lithography machines sold to China, impacting Chinese chipmakers like SMIC and Huawei.

Swiss sensor-maker LEM opens R&D facilities in Europe and Asia

LEM has opened new R&D centres in Munich and Shanghai to meet the rising global demand for current and voltage sensing driven by decarbonisation and electrification. The Munich facility will focus on ASIC and semiconductor tech, while Shanghai will enhance sensor intelligence. These expansions aim to improve global operations and customer service.

Samsung may set up semiconductor assembly line in Vietnam

Samsung Electronics is planning to expand its semiconductor operations by setting up an assembly line in Vietnam, where it already manufactures nearly half of its smartphones. This move supports Vietnam's goal of becoming a tech manufacturing hub. The government is offering incentives, though financial and location details are not yet disclosed.

US smartphone company OSOM shutting down

California-based smartphone startup OSOM, founded by Andy Rubin and Jason Keats, has announced its closure due to financial troubles and a lawsuit against CEO Keats for alleged misconduct. Despite privacy-focused products like the Saga smartphone, the company struggled with poor performance and failed partnerships, leading to its shutdown.

Suchi Semicon planning to build Gujarat's first OSAT facility before year end

Suchi Semicon will invest over \$100 million to build Gujarat's first OSAT facility by November 2024. The plant, spanning 2787 square metre

(30,000 square feet), will produce up to 3 million chips daily and create 1200 jobs. Partnering with local engineering colleges, Suchi Semicon aims to enhance local semiconductor production, reduce supply chain delays, and support India's growing tech sector.

Tata teams with Tokyo Electron for semicon equipment

Tata Electronics has signed an MoU with Tokyo Electron Limited (TEL) to enhance its semiconductor facilities in Gujarat and Assam. The agreement